

Incident, Emergency & Safeguarding Response

Recognise, respond, record and escalate

Suggested training type: Read + mini quiz Suggested pass mark: 80% Review/validity: 12 months recommended review cycle

Learning objectives

- Recognise incidents and indirect indicators of possible harm.
- Prioritise immediate safety and emergency response.
- Know the worker's responsibility to report and preserve information.
- Understand the difference between internal incident management and statutory reporting obligations.

1. What is an incident?

An incident can include injury, near miss, medication error, missing person concern, violence or aggression, abuse or neglect, property or environmental hazards, privacy/security events, unauthorised restrictive practices, or any event that affects or could affect participant safety and quality of support.

2. Immediate response

- Check immediate safety and provide appropriate assistance within your training.
- Call 000 where someone's life may be at risk or urgent emergency services are required.
- Do not leave a person in immediate danger.
- Notify the designated Opus Care supervisor/on-call contact as soon as practicable.
- Preserve relevant evidence and do not alter records.

3. Record facts

Record what happened, date/time/location, who was present, what you directly observed or were told, immediate actions taken, notifications made, injuries or consequences, and follow-up required. Separate facts from opinions.

4. Reportable incidents

Registered NDIS providers have specific statutory reporting obligations for reportable incidents. Opus Care workers should not personally decide that an incident is 'not reportable'. Workers report incidents internally promptly so the authorised manager can determine external notification requirements. The NDIS Commission's detailed incident guidance is also useful to unregistered providers.

5. Support the affected person

Incident management is not just paperwork. The person should be treated with dignity, kept informed in an accessible way, supported to feel safe, and involved in decisions about the response where appropriate.

Knowledge Check

Choose the best answer for each question. Suggested pass mark: 80%. This quiz checks understanding of the module; it does not replace supervised practical competency where that is required.

1. What is the first priority after a serious incident?
 - A. Complete paperwork before helping
 - B. Immediate safety and emergency response
 - C. Call the media
 - D. Wait for the next shift

2. When should 000 be called?
 - A. Only after manager approval
 - B. When someone's life may be at risk or urgent emergency help is required
 - C. For every late shift
 - D. Never by support workers

3. Who should decide whether statutory NDIS reporting is required?
 - A. Any worker acting alone
 - B. The authorised provider/manager using applicable requirements
 - C. The participant's neighbour
 - D. Nobody

4. What makes an incident record strong?
 - A. Facts, observations, actions and notifications
 - B. Rumours
 - C. Blame and emotional language
 - D. Deleting uncomfortable details

5. Can a near miss be important?
 - A. No
 - B. Yes, because it can reveal risk and prevention opportunities
 - C. Only if property was damaged
 - D. Only if police attended

Manager answer key is included in the accompanying quiz JSON file.

Source and reference notes

This Opus Care resource is an original internal training summary. It is based on current public guidance and does not reproduce third-party courses. Workers should use the linked official resources where specified.

- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/rules-and-standards/reportable-incidents-and-incident-management/incident-management>
- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/complaints/report>
- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/sites/default/files/2024-09/detailed-guidance-incident-management-systems-detailed-guidance-regi-20240926.pdf>

Important: Internal completion does not create a nationally recognised qualification, professional licence, or practical competency. Opus Care should verify external qualifications and practical skills appropriate to each worker's role and the supports actually delivered.